He took her hands in his. “I’d like that too.” He leaned in, his mouth near, his breath warm on her skin, but his lips did not touch her. Instead, his finger traced a line from her forehead down the side of her face, curving around her jaw, along her neck to the indent at the base of her throat. She felt the power of his touch, a doctor’s healing hand radiating the warmth of the sun, giving life. She lifted his hand to her mouth and kissed the palm. “I love you,” she whispered.

“I love you, too.” Now his mouth touched her mouth, and her fingers slid through his hair, soft as feathers. She closed her eyes and felt herself unraveling under his touch.

“Léa?”

“Yes?”

“Look at me.”

She opened her eyes. The room was gray and misty, but specks of light danced in the air between them.

“When I said we found each other, I mean you’ve opened something within me. I don’t know if another woman—”

“Could have torn you away from your patients?”

He laughed. “It’s more than that. You dragged me out of this long tunnel of despair I’d been walking through. I’d forgotten about love, light, warmth. The world isn’t a cold and dreary place; we don’t have to be alone—we can make the world what we want it to be. You’ve given me that gift. I want to spend the rest of my life looking into your beautiful eyes, getting lost in them, finding your eyes in our children.” His hands cupped her face, and she felt he was holding her whole world inside him.

“Will you marry me?”

“Yes.”

* * *

In the morning, she awoke entangled with him, her head against his solid, warm body. She smiled, unable to believe that she would spend every day of the rest of her life waking up like this. She had found her home in Josef’s arms, and she could see their future stretching before them, the sun shining beautiful and bright. Today, their future would start and if all went well, by afternoon, they’d be on the other side of the Elbe River, safely in the hands